QSAO CASE COMPETITION

Miami Heat: Contending Strategy

Data-Driven Roster Optimization & Acquisition Plan

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CURRENT SITUATION

Current Issues

- Middle-Bottom of the League
- Inefficient salary distribution
- Lacking direction

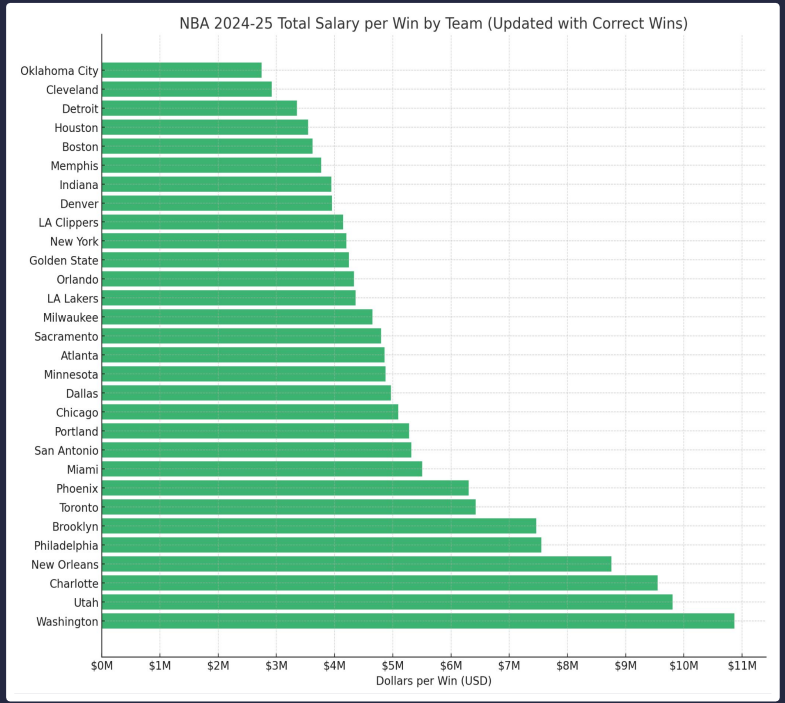
Team Performance

- 12th - Def.Rating
- 23rd - Offensive Rating
- 17th - Net Rating

Depth Concerns

- Lacking Rim Protection
- Lacking Playmaking

Salary Cap Overview



Details

- Like most teams, Miami is above salary cup but below luxury tax
- 9th highest in Salary/Win Ratio (176M, 32 Wins; 5.5 M/W)
- Three top 5 teams in the first four spots on this list: so this is a direction to move in
- Need to reduce excess salary and increase team's performance and financial efficiency

Our Plan

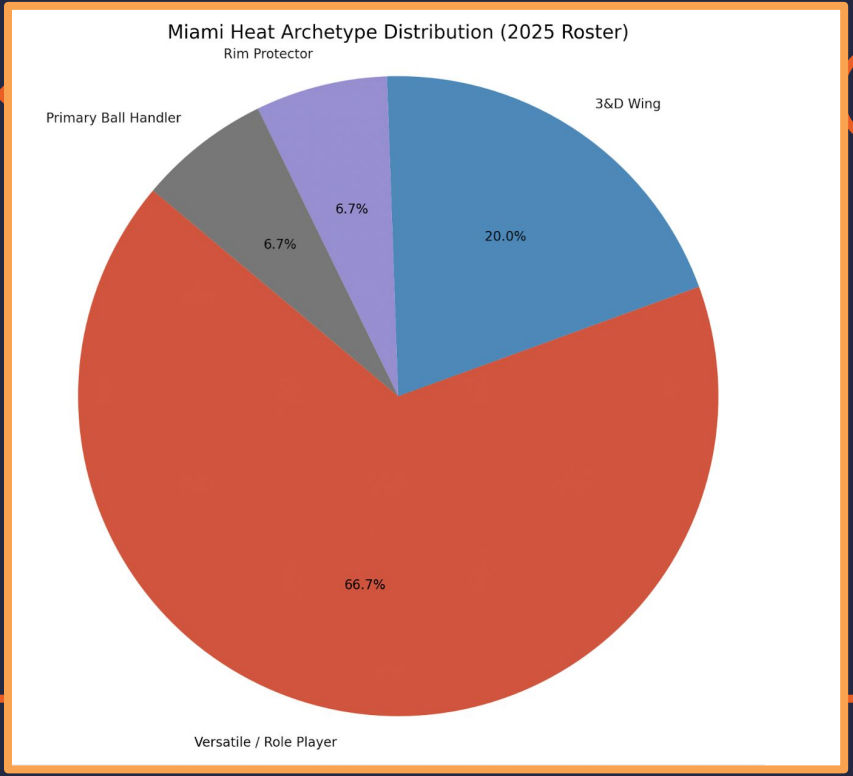
Timeline

- **2025 - 2026 (Retooling)**
  - 1 First Round Pick (GSW Protected)
- **2026-2027 (Compete)**
  - No First Round Pick
- **2027-2028 (Compete +)**
  - Current Core hits Prime Years

Goals

- Avoid a Tank and Retool
- Acquire young talent that aligns with our roster's primes
- Find more playmaking and rim protection

Miami Heat Archetype Distribution



Our Player-Evaluation Framework

Value Score

(PTS + 1.5 * AST + 1.2 * TRB + 2 * STL + 2 * BLK - TOV) * Efficiency

Value per $M

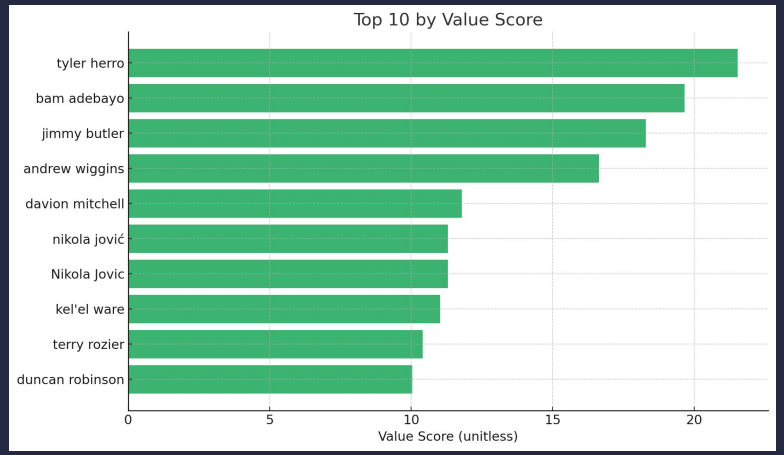
Value Score / (Salary in millions)

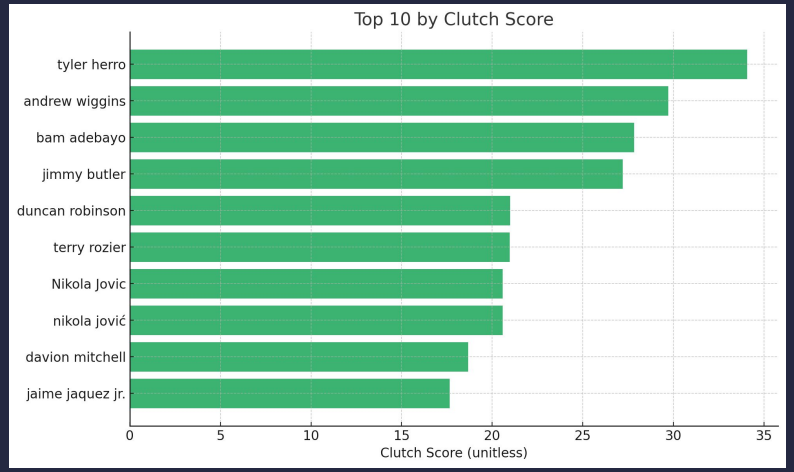
+/- per 36

Value Score / (MP / 36)

Clutch Score

(PTS + 2 * STL + FT% * 10) * Adjustment for experience


Top 10 by Value Score
tyler herro
bam adebayo
jimmy butler
andrew wiggins
davion mitchell
nikola jović
Nikola Jovic
kel'el ware
terry rozier
duncan robinson
0
5
10
15
20
Value Score (unitless)


Top 10 by Clutch Score
tyler herro
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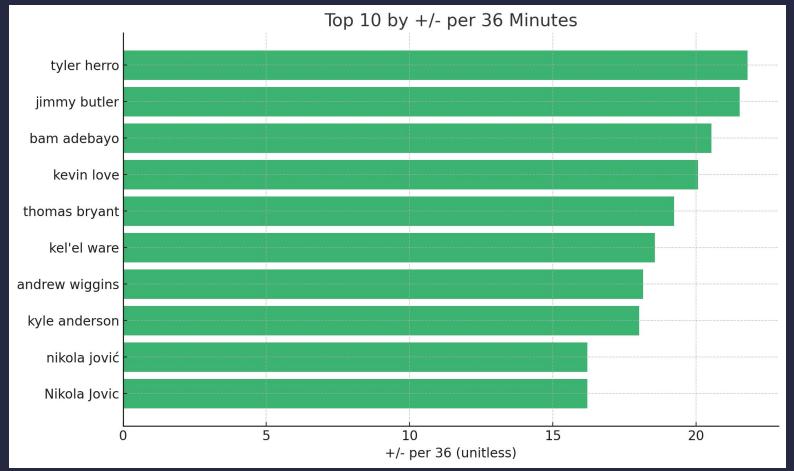
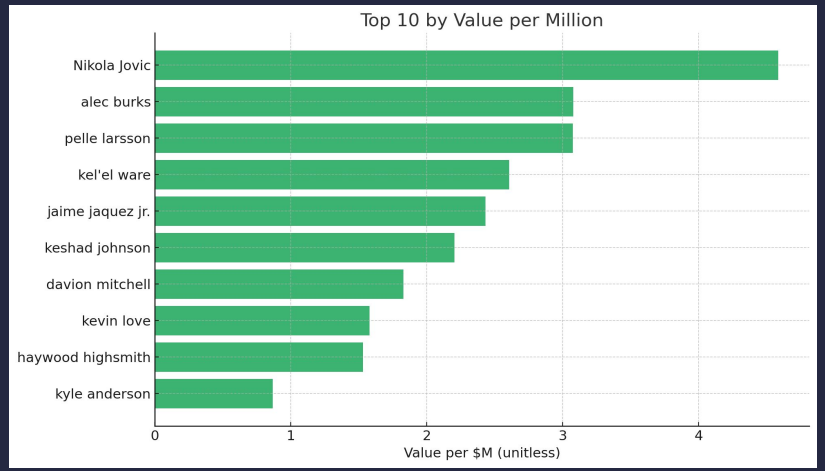
bam adebayo
jimmy butler
duncan robinson
terry rozier
Nikola Jovic
nikola jović
davion mitchell
jaime jaquez jr.
0
5
10
15
20
25
30
35
Clutch Score (unitless)


Top 10 by +/- per 36 Minutes
tyler herro
jimmy butler
bam adebayo
kevin love
thomas bryant
kel'el ware
andrew wiggins
kyle anderson
nikola jović
Nikola Jovic
0
5
10
15
20
+/- per 36 (unitless)


Top 10 by Value per Million
Nikola Jovic
alec burks
pelle larsson
kel'el ware
jaime jaquez jr.
keshad johnson
davion mitchell
kevin love
haywood highsmith
kyle anderson
0
1
2
3
4
Value per $M (unitless)

OUR TRADE PROPOSAL

TRADE AWAY

Terry Rozier

Salary: $24,924, 126

PG, 6-1, 190 lbs

Points: 11.2 PPG
Assists: 2.7 APG
Rebounds: 3.8 RPG

MIAMI HEAT

Duncan Robinson

Salary: $19,406,000

SG, 6-7, 215 lbs

Points: 11.0 PPG
Assists: 2.5 APG
Rebounds: 2.3 RPG

MIAMI HEAT

RECIEVE

Nic Claxton

Salary: $27,556,817

C, 6-11, 215 lbs

Points: 10.3 PPG
Assists: 2.2 APG
Rebounds: 7.6 RPG

NETS BROOKLYN

De'Anthony Melton

Salary: $12,822,000

SG, 6-2, 200 lbs

Points: 10.3 PPG
Assists: 2.8 APG
Rebounds: 3.3 RPG

NETS BROOKLYN

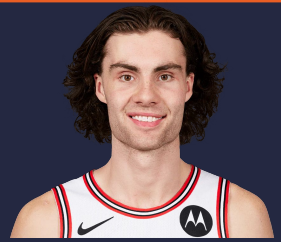
FREE AGENCY STRATEGY

Dennis Schroder (Brooklyn Nets)

PG, 6-1, 172 lbs

Points: 13.3 PPG
Assists: 5.4 APG
Rebounds: 2.6 RPG

Salary (2025-2026): Vet Min ($2 M)
Comparable to Spencer Dinwiddie



Josh Giddey (Chicago Bulls)

SF, 6-8, 210 lbs

Points: 19.4 PPG
Assists: 5.8 APG
Rebounds: 9.0 RPG

Salary (2025-2026): (~$40 M)
Comparable to Scottie Barnes

Steven Adams (Houston Rockets)

C, 6-11, 265 lbs

Points: 7.7 PPG
Assists: 1.2 APG
Rebounds: 9.6 RPC

Salary (2025-2026): Vet Min ($2 M)
Comparable to Thomas Bryant

FUTURE STEPS

What's the Plan?

- Retool the roster for the 2025-2026 by acquiring more talent for our weaknesses in rim-blocking and playmaking
- Retaining key contributors and trading away bad contracts

Retain Team Identity

- The Heat have made the playoffs the past 12/15 years and have an identity built off of being competitive
- Keeping Heat Culture by retooling and staying competitive, avoiding a tank and developing our new core

POST-TRADE DEPTH CHART

Josh Giddey (PG)

Tyler Herro (SG)

Bam Adebayo (PF)

Andrew Wiggins (SF)

Nic Claxton (C)

Other Key Players: *D. Schroder, S. Adams, J. Jaquez, K. Ware, N. Jovic, .. Rest of retaining roster*

THANK YOU!

MIAMI HEAT

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